SpeechGeek Presents



Female/Female Duos, Vol. 5

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SpeechGeek Presents: F/F Duos, Volume 5

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Be it Lucy and Ethel, Laverne and Shirley, or Tina (Fey) and Amy (Poehler), we here at SpeechGeek have always had a soft spot in our hearts for hilarious female tandems. Stumbling prat-falls and physical comedy? Women can do it. Deadpan dry wit? Not a problem for the ladies. Absurdist farce? Step aside boys; we got it.

So why is it so hard to find comedic material for two female performers?

Maybe it's just us, but we've found that finding pieces for ladies who like to play it up for laughs are *tough* to find. There are only so many times you can re-cast and re-imagine some scripts before they stop being enjoyable. That isn't really any fun, is it?

For this volume of Female/Female Duos – we wanted to avoid the drama and focus on the funny. Pop culture commentary shuffles across the stage in the parody "Dance Mamas." A lonely shut-in gets visited by a persistent saleswoman in "Selling the Farm." There's no death in this issue! (Except in "Gladys Has Left the Building," but we don't want to spoil it too much.)

Here's to all the ladies who love to make others laugh.

May your season be filled with smiles,

Corey Alderdice
Publisher



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Dance Mamas

by Clint Snyder

MAMA. Tabby, can I speak to you for a moment?

TABBY Z. There are no mothers allowed in the dance space. Why do you think the producers built a giant viewing space for you to sit in and gossip with the other mothers?

MAMA. Uh…

TABBY Z. I'll tell you why. It is so you could watch me run this dance studio like a sweatshop. Then you could occasionally burst in here and make me really angry, which in turn boosts our television ratings.

MAMA. I sa-

TABBY Z. I'm in the middle of a group rehearsal. Coincidentally, the number we're doing I've called "Why Am I So Much Like My Horrible Mother That Tabby Hates?" (*pause*) You know, something subtle that still has an artistic message.

MAMA. Well, it's just that…

TABBY Z. Spit it out, lady, before I chew you up and spit you out like a piece of tasty, tasty jerky!

MAMA. But Tabby, that just doesn't make any sense. If the jerky is tasty then why would you spit it out?

TABBY Z. I don't have time for this! (*aside*) Grande Jete! Plié! Straighten out those hooves you call feet, melon head!

MAMA. It's just that some of the other dance mamas and I were talking, and we just feel that…

TABBY Z. That's what you do! That's what you *always* do! You sit up there and you talk, you talk and talk and bur, bur, bur, bur, bur!

MAMA. What does that mean?

TABBY Z. It means you're interrupting my class! I'm trying to educate children. (*aside*) Straighten those feet tubby! Do you ever want to be on Broadway? Not with those wonky legs!

MAMA. That's actually what we've been meaning to talk to you about. We don't like how you treat the children.

TABBY Z. How I treat the children? I'm sorry, do you know how to teach dance?

MAMA. No.

TABBY Z. Do I know what I'm talking about?

MAMA. No.

TABBY Z. (*pause, oblivious*) Wait, what we were talking about? (*aside*) Step-ball-change! This isn't a Spanish Opera House! This is my house!

MAMA. I thought this was your studio?

TABBY Z. Yes…and also my house. See, that's my stuffed golden retriever over there in the corner. I've had to live here for five years because CRAB LEGS OVER THERE HASN'T BEEN ABLE TO STRAIGHTEN HER FEET SINCE SHE WALKED OUT OF THE WOMB!

MAMA. Right there. We were talking about is how you are always so hard on the kids.

TABBY Z. Erhm…

MAMA. They're starting to have some emotional and deeply rooted psycho logical problems.

TABBY Z. Those kids are happy! See that stupid one over there prancing around with her legs bent? (*aside*) I will throw a chair at you!

MAMA. We just feel that the stress of being on a reality television show with cameras around constantly while being screamed at like they are in a labor camp is starting to wear on them a little bit.

TABBY Z. What cameras? I don't see any cameras. All I see is lil' ol' me with my gorgeous head of hair and massive amount of talent flowing through each one of my tiny feminine fingers. (*fluffs her hair and winks at a camera*)

MAMA. I know, they're so hard to notice! (*fluffs her hair up and winks at the camera*)

TABBY Z. What isn't hard to notice is your kid falling out of her turns every five seconds. That kid is a mess. She is hot garbage on a plastic platter.

MAMA. Let's not make this about the kids, Tabby.

TABBY Z. It's always about the kids!

MAMA. I know, but…

TABBY Z. It's always about the kids!

MAMA. Well, I know that. Everyone here has the children's best interests at heart.

TABBY Z. (*aside)* LIFT THOSE FAT MONKEY FEET OR I'LL BREAK THEM OFF!

MAMA. We're always thinking of the children. That's why the cameras have to pan to us fighting all the time. We want to give them a break to take their coffee and painkillers.

TABBY Z. Again, what cameras are you talking about? (*winks and blows a kiss*)

MAMA. (*to audience*) We're on the social media, too! (*winks*)

TABBY Z. Do you see that sign up there?

MAMA. No. I've had so much plastic surgery done it has become difficult for me to close my eyes.

TABBY Z. Then I'll read it for you! It says "Caution: Wet Floor." Wait, that's the wrong sign. (*pause*) For goodness sakes, look monkey! I don't care if you fell down. Get up and dance it again!

MAMA. I guess some children just don't read.

TABBY Z. Right. The sign next to that says "Tabby Z's P… Pance Company"? Oh well, that must be a typo. What it means is that every time your kid is out there flopping around like a fish in a frying pan – *I'm* the one who looks like an idiot.

MAMA. Well, it's not just you. Every time my little potato gets fifth or sixth place, I get letters from people who tell me I should have adopted!

Most of the time, I just write back and tell them I already knew that. (*beat)* Ooops, I think she heard me.

TABBY Z. (*aside*) Does that mean stop dancing, moron?

MAMA. (*aside)* It's all right, sweetie. Mama will buy you some ice cream on the way home. Her bank account is mighty full from the divorce.

TABBY Z. Ice cream… That's not a bad idea. What was I talking about? Oh yeah, signs.

MAMA. Signs.

TABBY Z. Don't repeat what I'm saying. (*glaring*) If you can't read that one, maybe you can read the one underneath that says "Exit" because if you don't like me screaming at your kid, then take her somewhere else.

MAMA. But the other dance studios aren't on television. Every mother here wants their children to learn how to become great dancers, but more importantly, they want to be on television mocking and criticizing the other children while they do it.

TABBY Z. As I said: if you don't like it, you can leave. And while you're out, could you pick me up something to eat? I'm starving.

MAMA. I'm sorry. We've given up food so that everyone looks better on television.

TABBY Z. That's ridiculous! Why wouldn't you eat?

MAMA. Oh, I don't mean myself and the other mothers. I just mean the kids. See, we find that if we have food just laying around in our purses, the children might find it and sneak a few bites. We wouldn't want people to see our children on television looking plump. They would think that we're bad parents.

TABBY Z. Right.

MAMA. I mean, honestly, no one likes someone that looks all "fleshy" and "healthy" on television. They need to look lithe, delicate, and hungry. *Hungry for success*, that is. That's just where I'm at with my little pumpkin right now. REMEMBER HEALTHY IS HORRIBLE DARLING!

TABBY Z. (*gasps and pauses*) You. Are. OUT OF HERE! OUT-A-RONI! THE OPPOSITE OF IN!

MAMA. Why? I was just saying that to stir up some drama! The production crew loves that kind of stuff.

TABBY Z. I know, but you're taking up too much of my camera time. You're out!!!

MAMA. We signed a contract with the television producers. We can't leave.

TABBY Z. Yeah, and you also signed a contract with my dance studio. In that contract I threw in a bunch of little surprises. On page twenty-nine it says that they can't leave and go to another dance studio.

MAMA. I already knew that.

TABBY Z. Right, but on page 786 it says that your child's soul becomes my property.

MAMA. I didn't get that far. Who has time to read anyway?

TABBY Z. I know right? I had one of the kids write it for me, I told them I would give them a solo. And then… I didn't! HA!

MAMA. (*laughs*) You know what, Abby? You're really funny. Like, when you were just saying that thing about reading the whole time I was like, "Duh! I would rather be shopping or drinking or getting plastic surgery or ignoring my children."

TABBY Z. Yeah… I'm a pretty good person aren't I? (*aside*) SMILE YOU STUPID SEALS! FACIAL EXPRESSION IS EVERYTHING! I DON'T UNDERSTAND WHY YOU'RE NOT SMILING WHILE YOU'RE DANCING!

MAMA. I don't even know why we fight most of the time.

TABBY Z. It makes for good television. I mean… Uhh… It's good for the children. (*winks at camera*)

MAMA. Yeah, let's go with that.

TABBY Z. Are they almost done filming this episode? I'm getting hungry.

MAMA. I think so. The camera guy just spent awhile shooting B role of one of the kids bleeding everywhere.

TABBY Z. Well, in that case… (*to camera*) Are you getting this? Good. You kids are out of the group dance!

MAMA. But, Tabby, why!? (*plays to camera*)

TABBY Z. Because she needs to learn to fix her stupid feet! I've tried every thing, including stapling them together! Nothing works on that kid! She's out!

MAMA. But Tabby! You're so cruel! (*overdramatic*) All I want for my child is to experience the love and joy of dance while I make hundreds of thousands of dollars doing nothing! Is that so much to ask? I am a good mother! (*smiles to camera*)

TABBY Z. I am the only chance that kid is ever going to have at being happy! Look at her diddling around over there like an idiot. Just look at how gosh darn happy she is!

MAMA. I know that! And that is the only reason why we put up with your gosh darn silliness every week! For the joy that it brings our children!

TABBY Z. POINT YOUR TOES, YOU GIRAFFES! This is a dance studio not a zoo! Keep acting like that and we'll throw some peanuts at you!

MAMA. Remember their diet.

TABBY Z. Right. I'm not going to throw peanuts at you pukes! I'm going to throw fireworks until it looks like the Fourth of July in here! That would be something to celebrate because no one is celebrating your sickle feet! (*to self*) Actually that seems like it might make a good dance. I'll call it "Is She a Firecracker Or a Burn Victim?" And I want to see those little eggheads sparkle! POP! SPARKLE! POP!

MAMA. I just don't know what I'll do if my daughter isn't allowed to do the group dance! That's completely detrimental to my, I mean, *her* career!

TABBY Z. Well, fine then! You want to sit here and talk about it like grown

adults? I don't do that! I get crazy! Blah! (*to camera*) You're still getting all this footage right? This going to be gold here in a minute. (*back to MAMA*) Where was I? (*clears throat*) I get crazy!

MAMA. Tabby what are you saying?

TABBY Z. I'm saying not only is she out of the number, she's out of here! See that sign! Not the one that says BG's Tires, that's just where I get my oil changed. *That* one that has my name on it.

MAMA. I do! I do see it!

TABBY Z. That sign means I can do whatever I want! She's out. In fact, you're all out! I'll dance the group number by myself. Watch me. Plié! Grande Jete! Dance you moron, or I'll break your legs! Ha! See I'm even good at motivating myself! This number is going to get first place for sure!

MAMA. You're insane!

TABBY Z. Yes, I am! And you had better watch out or I'll bite you! (*She chomps at the air. Both are suddenly completely tame smiling.*) That's going to be great for the ratings.

MAMA. I know, right?

TABBY Z. Where did your kid go?

MAMA. Who cares?

Selling the Farm

by Clint Snyder

(Vivianne, a recluse on a farm answers the door to find Barbara, a push vacuum saleswoman. If possible the characters, Vivianne in particular, should be played with thick Midwestern accents.)

VIVIANNE. (*peeks out cautiously*) Hello? The milkman doesn't usually come until Tuesday. Plus, I don't order milk because I'm lactose intoler ant. I'm also very dangerous. I have mace. So if you're planning any funny business, I have mace! Mace and a… ummm… slightly bad temper!

BARBARA. HELLLO!!!!!

VIVIANNE. Ahhhh! Eat door, criminal! (*slams the door on her foot several times.*)

BARBARA. Quite a spirit you have there!

VIVIANNE. Why aren't you in excruciating pain! I've been slamming the door… (*keeps slamming*) on your… foot!

BARBARA. HA!

VIVIANNE. Oh my goodness. Are you a vampire? I read my fortune this morning and it said, "Expect the past to come back your way." Being the cautious woman I am, I knew instantly that the undead were coming back to life.

BARBARA. I'm not dead!

VIVIANNE. Of course you're not! You're *undead*! (*slamming the door, accenting each word*) Go! Back! To! Your! Grave! You! Zombie! I will not have my juicy, delicious brain eaten! Not now! I have far too many crock-pot recipes up there! And you will not have them… Why aren't you falling down?

BARBARA. HA! Steel-toed boots!

VIVIANNE. (*to self)* Far too advanced…(*to Barbara)* You must be one of those television zombies. I knew I should have invested in a bomb shelter! Oh, why did Hank have to go and get blown up in that tractor incident? All my money went to the funeral. If we weren't so landlocked, I would have had a funeral at sea.

BARBARA. Ha!

VIVIANNE. Why are you laughing at me? I have been through a lot. Get away!

BARABARA: Well… I would get away, but I just can't help (*pauses to change course*) but help out my fellow man.

VIVIANNE. I'm a woman!

BARBARA. Really?

VIVIANNE. (*pause*) Really.

BARBARA. I'm sorry. I just assumed from the state of your apartment that you must be some slovenly young bachelor wasting your time chasing young girls at college while there is *dirt*! DIRT AND FILTH! AND FILTHY DIRT SURROUNDING EVERY CORNER OF YOUR BEING!

VIVIANNE. AHHHHH!!!

BARBARA. AHHHH!!!

VIVIANNE. Ahhh?

BARBARA. Ahhh!

VIVIANNE. Wait… Why am I so scared?

BARBARA. I'll tell you why you're scared: dirt. Dirt that the human eye cannot perceive attracts more dirt! And do you know what that attracts?

VIVIANNE. What? What does it attract? Please, tell me! (*increasingly nervous)*

BARBARA. Well, it's not men!

VIVIANNE. Of course not, there haven't been men around this farm in years—or women, children, or animals—now that I think about it. Only things around here are just these cute little ceramic chickens! I call this one Matthew. I call this one Matt, this little one over here is Matthew, Jr., and this proud little lady in the apron is Matina! The foreign cooking chicken that cooks chicken.

BARBARA. Do you know what I call this one right here?

VIVIANNE. Me?

BARBARA. You!

VIVIANNE. Me!?

BARBARA. You…

VIVIANNE. (*pause*, *quietly*) Me?

BARBARA. Pathetic!

VIVIANNE. Ohhhhhh!!!! It's awful! Don't look at me!

BARBARA. I can't look at you!

VIVIANNE. DON'T LOOK AT ME!!!!

BARBARA. There is dirt everywhere! FILTH! But I know what you need!

VIVIANNE. What? Please tell me what I need.

BARBARA. I don't know if you're ready for this…

VIVIANNE. Please! I'm ready. I've been waiting my whole life for this moment. I've been petting my ceramic chickens and writing in my diary waiting for someone to come save me from this nightmare! THIS FARM IS A NIGHTMARE! NO, I WILL NOT POLISH YOU WILMA! YOU ARE JUST A CERMAIC CHICKEN AND ONLY NEED TO BE POLISHED EVERY OTHER DAY!

BARBARA. (*pause*) Ok, I think you might be ready.

VIVIANNE. Teach me to live a better life, you strange mystical woman.

BARBARA. The only thing that you need to improve your sad existence is…

VIVIANNE. Tell me! The suspense is killing me!

BARBARA. Okay. You might want to sit down for this.

VIVIANNE. I'm afraid if I sit down I just might pass out.

BARBARBA: I don't want to alarm you.

VIVIANNE. Ohhh… golly…

BARBARA. But the only this you need…

VIVIANNE. Yes! Yes!

BARBARA. …is (*dramatic pause)* this vacuum!

VIVIANNE. Oh.

BARBARA. You sound disappointed.

VIVIANNE. I was just expecting something a little more…*inspirational*… like a really cute ceramic cat, book, or a big bowl of potato salad.

BARBARA. Do you see these hose attachments? THIS IS THE DEFINITION OF INSPIRATION!

VIVIANNE. I don't know if I buy that.

BARBARA. I don't know if you'll buy that either, but I do know you'll buy this vacuum.

VIVIANNE. How can you possibly know that? I am a very thrifty shopper! I go to yard sales and thrift stores. Sometimes I'll even pick furniture out of the dumpster.

BARBARA. That's how I found you, actually. I saw you stuffing clothes from the thrift store in your clothes.

VIVIANNE. You didn't see anything!

BARBARA. Oh, don't worry. The only thing that I saw was a girl with a nose for a bargain—a big nose for a big bargain.

VIVIANNE. I didn't steal anything!

BARBARA. Of course you didn't, but it's pretty hard to miss a woman who stuffs twenty-three tube tops, two high heels, and a very used corset into her blouse.

VIVIANNE. It was twenty-one, and I had a coupon for the corset!

BARBARA. I'm not blaming anyone for anything! It was a compliment. You are a girl who knows where she's going!

VIVIANNE. Yeah?

BARBARA. Yeah! She's going to vacuum the floor!

VIVIANNE. I'm going to vacuum the floor! (*pause*) Wait, why am I doing that? This floor has not been vacuumed in over ten years.

BARBARA. Exactly.

VIVIANNE. What do you mean by *that*?

BARBARA. Not to touch a sensitive issue but, Vivianne—may I call you Vivianne?

VIVIANNE. Yes, you may.

BARBARA. I don't want to pry around a sensitive subject, but when was the last the last time that you've had a date?

VIVIANNE. OUUUUCHHH!!!

BARBARA. Oh, my goodness! What?

VIVIANNE. You've touched a sensitive subject.

BARBARA. I thought I might have.

VIVIANNE. Can I be frank with you?

BARBARA. You can. Frank, will you please tell me all of your issues… Go!

VIVIANNE. Oh goodness…

BARBARA. GOOOOO!!!

VIVIANNE. When I was three, the other kids used to make fun of me because I was fat. Since my favorite food was liverwurst sandwiches, they called me Queen Liverwurst and my kingdom was supposedly called Hog Town. I have a zit on my body that has been there for

three years. When I go to bed at night, sometimes I cry because of all the ceramic cats out there that don't have a good home and an owner to feed them imaginary cat food every night. I don't get out much. I still wet the bed sometimes so I wrap an extra pair of bedsheets together and pin them up with clothes hangers like an adult diaper.

BARBARA. Is that all?

VIVIANNE. Yes. (*pause)* Oh, and well, I know this is kind of hard to believe, but (*whispers loudly*) I don't have very many friends.

BARBARBA: No!

VIVIANNE. Yes.

BARBARBA: NO!

VIVIANNE. YES!!

BARBARA. NO!!!

VIVIANNE. (*sheepishly*) Yes?

BARBARA. Well, all that is over now because your life is about to change forever!

VIVIANNE. Oh, thank goodness because that's what was actually on my to-do list this morning. I said Vivianne, you sloppy Queen of the Liverwurst, you are going to do one of two things today: either you are going to change that sad pathetic existence you call a life, or you're going to buy a cute kitty figure with a top hat for your collection.

BARBARA. Well today's the day!

VIVIANNE. Really?! You have one with a top ha-

BARBARA. YOUR LIFE WILL CHANGE FOREVER! You can kiss your sad life goodbye because of the TORNADO TOWER 5000!

VIVIANNE. Ooooohhh!

BARBARA. Who needs friends, Vivianne, when you have the best friend a gal can have right here?

VIVIANNE. You'll be my friend! (*excited and hopeful*)

BARBARA. No! Of course not, stinky. I was talking about the vacuum.

VIVIANNE. Oh.

BARBARA. But you haven't let me show you the best part.

VIVIANNE. I'm so excited I might pee myself!

BARBARA. You know those whoosing turbines on jets?

VIVANNE: I don't travel very much.

BARBARA. I can't be positive, but I think it may be made from the same technology.

VIVIANNE. Oooohhhh!

BARBARA. And I'm pretty su-

VIVANNE: Yes! (*overexcited*)

BARBARA. Would you let me finish?! That's really rude. If you interrupt my sales pitch again, I'm going to take off one of these hose attachments and beat you with it.

VIVIANNE. Sorry.

BARBARA. The only thing that you should be sorry about is the fact that you don't have one of these puppies right now!

VIVIANNE. I prefer cats.

BARBARA. Listen, I don't have any scientific data to prove this, but I think this is the very same vacuum that Lance Armstrong used to clean up all that moon dust.

VIVIANNE. Neil.

BARBARA. Don't correct me…. (*stern look, points finger menacingly)* I'm going show you the best part. Let's turn it on. (*she does*) What can you hear?

VIVIANNE. (*pause*) Nothing. I hear nothing!

BARBARA. Exactly.

VIVIANNE. I must be deaf! I knew I should have taken those hearing tests when I was a child, but instead mother just yelled into my ear and told me that was sufficient.

BARBARA. No, you're hearing is just fine. The Tornado Tower 5000 comes with all the power of a wind storm, but is completely silent.

VIVIANNE. Oh. (*disappointed*)

BARBARA. What?

VIVIANNE. It's just… I actually kind of like the sound of a vacuum. I know that sounds strange, but I've always found it very soothing. It drowns out the voices in my head.

BARBARA. Did I say silent?

VIVIANNE. Yes.

BARBARA. Wow, maybe you should get your hearing checked out after all. Or maybe you just couldn't hear me over the sound of this ridiculously loud melodic vacuum.

VIVIANNE. What?

BARBARA. (*making vacuum noises*) VRRRRRMMMMMMMMM!

VIVIANNE. Oh, how nice!

BARBARA. VRRRRRMMMMMMM!!!!!

VIVIANNE. It's like music to my ears! A sweet lullaby! I might fall asleep here!

BARBARA. VR-VR-VR…. (*She makes a noise as if the loud vacuum is powering down.*) VACCUUM OFF!

VIVIANNE. And it talks, too!

BARBARA. Like I said, it's your best friend.

VIVIANNE. Did you hear that?! I'm going to call you Gloria, vacuum, because you're like my great aunt Gloria. You're loud, obsessively clean, and everyone pushes you around!

BARBARA. And it can be all yours—as long as you pay.

VIVIANNE. How much is it?

BARBARA. Oh, we'll get to that in a moment. I want to make sure that you get to see this baby in action first.

VIVIANNE. I'm ready! Oh, Gloria! Show me what you can do!

BARBARA. You see this topsoil? (*holding a bag of topsoil*)

VIVIANNE. Yes… Yes, I do.

BARBARA. (*dumps the bag*) Well, now it's on your carpet!

VIVIANNE. AHHHHH!!!!

BARBARA. There's no need to panic—not with the Tornado Tower 5000 here!

VIVIANNE. Oh, help me, Gloria! Help me! Help me!

BARBARA. Watch this. (*starts vacuuming*)

VIVIANNE. I don't think you turned it on.

BARBARA. Oh right, silly me… (*mimes turning it on again.*) BRRRRRRRRR!!!!! VRRRRRMMM! VACCUM OFF NOW!

VIVIANNE. Oh, thank you Gloria!

BARBARA. (*vacuum voice*) Please buy me Vivianne, help your auntie out!

VIVIANNE. Oh, I will Gloria!

BARBARA. You don't see any topsoil, right?

VIVIANNE. Actually, there's still quite a bit still left on the carpet.

BARBARA. There's less than when I started.

VIVIANNE. No, because when you started there was none, and then you dumped a bunch of topsoil on my carpet.

BARBARA. That's beside the point. The point is that this vacuum—your melodic sweet sounding friend Gloria—can be yours.

VIVIANNE. How much?

BARBARA. You can have it for the low, low cost of the deed to your family farm.

VIVIANNE. What? I can't. This farm has been in the family for generations!

BARBARA. I understand how you feel. Other customers have felt the same way, but what they've found is that…

VIVIANNE. No! I can't!

BARBARA. I understand how you feel. Other customers have felt the same way, but what they've found is that…

VIVIANNE. Why do you keep saying that?!

BARBARA. I understand how you feel. Other customers have felt the same way, but what they've found is that…

VIVIANNE. You're freaking me out! Okay! Okay! I'll do it!

BARBARA. (*Pause. Smiles, in vacuum voice.*) Thank you, Vivianne. Now I can live happily in your home with you and your stupid ceramic dog collection forever!

VIVIANNE. (*gasps loudly*)

BARBARA. (*returns to regular voice*) What?

VIVIANNE. I do NOT collect ceramic DOGS, (*She spits, disgusted at the idea.)* Cats! I collect ceramic cats! The very idea!

BARBARA. Well I…

VIVIANNE. Not another word out of you! You, miss, are a sham! A thief! A liar! Get out of my house! And take "Gloria"—if that really is the vacuum's name—with you!

BARBARA. But I-

VIVIANNE. GET OUT! (*pushing her out the door, then a long pause*) Some people are just nuts, thinking they were going to try to sell me a talking vacuum after insulting me like that! What does she think I am, crazy? (*laughs)*

Gladys Has Left the Building

by Gregg Moeller

LURLEEN. Mavis—Thank God you came!

MAVIS. Lurleen—It is three o'clock in the sam-hill A.M. morning—just why are you convening a meetin' of the "Love Me Tender" Elvis Forever Club?

LURLEEN. I've done sumthin' I ain't proud of, Mabel…something positively… eee-vull.

MAVIS. Eee-vull, huh? Worse than the night you drank a bottle of MD 20/20 and thought you were Eleanor Roosevelt back from the dead?

LURLEEN. Worse… Much worse….

MAVIS. Even worse than the time you broke up with Buford and thought that shooting every street sign featuring the letter "B" was a good idea? You're still not allowed within fifty feet of the Bar-B-Que Barn!

LURLEEN. Worse than that…

MAVIS. Okay—worse than Felipe, the circus contortionist?

LURLEEN. (*smiles briefly*) Oh…worse than…that…

MAVIS. Well, my stars and garters, what did you go and do now?

LURLEEN. First—we gotta do the "Love Me Tender" Elvis Forever Club Membership Oath of Eternal Sisterhood.

MAVIS. It's Three A.M. Even God is asleep.

LURLEEN. Do it!

MAVIS. Oh for the love of… Fine!

BOTH. We pledge allegiance to the king of us all—the Lord High and Mighty Elvis Aron Presley—and to the "oooohhh" for which we stand—and may that hussy Priscilla rot in hell. Amen."

MAVIS. Now, will you—

LURLEEN. "Love Me Tender" Elvis Forever Club member Mavis Spackle: will you commence with the reading of the minutes of our last meeting?

MAVIS. I will not. We don't keep minutes. And just what is eating you girl?

LURLEEN. Rules of order, Sister Mavis. This is a civilized society we live in.

MAVIS. Fine. Sister Lurleen, I would like to make a motion to make you tell me just what the devil is goin' on?

LURLEEN. Mavis, I've been a bad, BAD "Love Me Tender" Elvis Forever Club member… The worst ever…

MAVIS. Lurleen, we are the only members—at least until Vera gets out of detox.

LURLEEN. I…have sinned. In heart and deed…

MAVIS. Did you moon the high school track team AGAIN?

LURLEEN. NO! This is far worse… FAR worse.

MAVIS. All right—let's use the Elvis Movie Scale… Just how bad? *Hare-um Scare-um* bad? *Fun in Acapulco* bad?

LURLEEN. No…

MAVIS. You…don't..mean…*CLAMBAKE* bad?

LURLEEN. Yes…yes! (*drops to knees*) Our Elvis who art in Heaven, Hallowed be thy hair…"

MAVIS. (*pulls up LURLEEN*) Lurleen—there is NUTHIN' that goes beyond *Clambake*! That's the DEFCON 1 of Elvis sins!

LURLEEN. Meet… DefCom 6…squared… (*drags in a large object*)

MAVIS. Lurleen…that is a casket. A dead body casket.

LURLEEN. I know that! I'm not stupid.

MAVIS. That's kinda questionable, right now…

LURLEEN. I just got scared… The other day I was getting my perm—

MAVIS. Doris do that?

LURLEEN. Yes!

MAVIS. She is a hair savant.

LURLEEN. May I continue?

MAVIS. Please do.

LURLEEN. Well, I was getting my perm—from Doris—when I was lookin' at a copy of *The National Enquirer*…and you will NOT guess what that tramp Priscilla wants to do with Graceland!

MAVIS. Elvis really should've married Ann-Margret. They were so perfect in *Viva Las Vegas*.

LURLEEN. May I continue?

MAVIS. Yes—please tell me why you have a casket in your trailer.

LURLEEN. Priscilla wants to turn Graceland into… "Elvis Land"—a theme park!

MAVIS. God will GET her for that.

LURLEEN. She wants to make Graceland into a tourist trap, with All Shook Up Roller Coasters and Burning Love Tunnels! She even wants to put wild animals in the Jungle Room!

MAVIS. Sack-rilege!

LURLEEN. And I gots to thinkin' about poor Elvis—hallowed be thy name—lying in the Garden of Remembrance underneath the Heartbreak Hotel Tilt-a-Whirl…defiled by tourists throwing up all over his mortal remains…and I had an epiphany.

MAVIS. A whut?

LURLEEN. An epiphany… I had to save Elvis.

MAVIS. (*pause*) Uh…Lurleen… WHO is IN the casket, pray tell?

LURLEEN. His High and Mighty. Our Brylcreemed Lord and Savior. Elvis Aron Presley.

MAVIS. But—Graceland—the guards…

LURLEEN. There's nothing that a woman with a backhoe and the support of Johnny Walker Red can't do.

MAVIS. How…but… Didn't anyone try to STOP you?

LURLEEN. I just told the security guards that Jennifer Lopez was buck naked in the Music Room demanding a private tour. They were gone like that (*snaps fingers*). Men are such sheep.

MAVIS. Holy hound dog, Lurleen!

LURLEEN. Genuflect in his holy presence, Mavis! (*both drop*)

MAVIS. Elvis Presley is in your trailer, Lurleen…

LURLEEN. Shush… Even in death, he commands your respect. You're safe, now, Elvis… (*BOTH start chanting "Love Me Tender")*

Love me tender,
love me sweet,
never let me go.
You have made my life complete,
and I love you so.
Love me tender,
love me true…

MAVIS. Um…Lurleen…why is Elvis's casket pink?

LURLEEN. (*continues chanting*) *all my dreams fulfilled.*
For my darlin' I love you,
and I always will.

MAVIS. Lurleen—Elvis was buried in a white casket. This one's pink.

LURLEEN. (*ignores Mavis*)
Love me tender,
love me long,
take me to your heart.
For it's there that I belong,
and we'll never part.

MAVIS. Lurleen! You have a bright pink casket in your trailer and I have a suspicion it does NOT contain Elvis—our lord and savior.

LURLEEN. *Love me tender,*
love me dear,
tell me you are mine.
I'll be yours through all the years,
till the end of time.

MAVIS. Cut out the danged chanting and listen to me! Do you remember which grave you dug up at Graceland?

LURLEEN. Well…they were all together…it was dark…so I just guessed…

MAVIS. YOU GUESSED? There are four graves at Graceland—Elvis (*our lord and savior*), his daddy Vernon, his mama Gladys and his grandmamma. WHICH ONE DID YOU DIG UP?

LURLEEN. I was in a bit of a rush—digging up caskets is not exactly encour aged by the population.

MAVIS. Okay—explain what you did tonight… Be thorough.

LURLEEN. Well, I got the backhoe through the loading area, after I told the lie about Jennifer Lopez being buck naked in the Music Room. *Forgive me for lying in your presence, Elvis…*

MAVIS. Focus, Lurleen—FOCUS! What did you do next?

LURLEEN. I pulled out the log chain you got me for Christmas last year—those things are so handy!

MAVIS. FOCUS, Lurleen… Eyes on the prize…

LURLEEN. And I wrapped the chain around the top of the vault and ripped it open like a can of hickory smoked Spam! And that's when I pulled

out Elvis and saved him from Priscilla's sinful plans. Thy will be done!

MAVIS. Lurleen, this ain't Elvis.

LURLEEN. It *is* Elvis. I wouldn't have gone through all of this just for any dead body!

MAVIS. There's only one way to find out. We're going in.

LURLEEN. You want to desecrate Elvis' casket?

MAVIS. Lurleen, you ripped it out of Graceland and dragged it across Memphis behind your Buick with a log chain. It has already been desecrated enough.

LURLEEN. But, it seems so…disrespectful. To open it up, just to look… Sounds kinda perverted. (*pause*)

MAVIS. Said the woman who just dragged a very much in use casket into her living room at three in the morning.

LURLEEN. Point taken. Here's a crow bar. But first, we must pay our respects. Oh, our lord Elvis, we thank you for the bounty that you have seen fit to grant us, and we promise to respect your most holiest dead body with respect. Amen.

(*reverent pause—then both begin to attack the coffin*)

LURLEEN. Use your back—make the weight work for you!

MAVIS. You callin' me fat?

LURLEEN. I'm calling you a wimp! Okay—on three. One… Two… Three—PULL!!!

(*BOTH pull backwards, and fall over—then stand up to examine the coffin's contents*)

LURLEEN. Mavis… Why is Elvis wearing a dress?

MAVIS. Unless Elvis was a transvestite in the afterlife, I don't think you dug up Elvis, Lurleen.

LURLEEN. Elvis is wearing a dress!

MAVIS. Lurleen—listen to me—this is NOT Elvis!

LURLEEN. Then if it ain't Elvis, then who is this dead and rather decomposed person we got then?

(*BOTH look at each other, and then turn to the coffin in horror.*)

BOTH: Gladys!

LURLEEN. Sweet Jesus! I dug up Elvis's momma!

MAVIS. You couldn't read the names on the markers?

LURLEEN. Hey, at 3 A.M. "Gladys" and "Elvis" look pretty much the same!

MAVIS. Let's try to figure out what to do here… I *cannot* believe this…

LURLEEN. Gladys Presley, I'm Lurleen Cole, and this is Mavis Spackle…

MAVIS. Hi…what am I saying?

LURLEEN. I just want you to know that we are huge fans of your son—our lord and savior—and that we're pleased as punch to have stolen you and made your acquaintance (*tries to shake Gladys' hand—it comes off*) AAAUGH! Her hand came off! I'm holding Gladys Presley's hand!

MAVIS. I think the drive from Graceland knocked her jaw loose, as well…

LURLEEN. (*realizes*) Hey, I'm holding Gladys Presley's hand! This was the hand that raised Elvis and helped teach him to be a good boy.

MAVIS. It's also ripped from the rest of her arm.

LURLEEN. (*shocked*) I dug up Elvis's momma and drug her across Memphis!

MAVIS. We got that part.

LURLEEN. I just dismembered Gladys Presley!

MAVIS. Again, we have that covered.

LURLEEN. I am soaked with sin! Elvis shalt smite me for my misdeeds!

MAVIS. No one's getting smited, Lurleen… We just gotta figure out a way to get Mrs. Presley back to Graceland without getting arrested.

LURLEEN. Oh, Lurleen—Elvis is so mad at me right now.

MAVIS. We'll just put Gladys into my Suburban and haul her back. They have to know she's been taken.

LURLEEN. Especially after Jennifer Lopez was a no-show… I am just not ready for the "Jailhouse Rock," Mavis!

MAVIS. The police will be all over Graceland and reporters will be every where… But you know what, Lurleen? You may have saved Graceland!

LURLEEN. How? I dug up Elvis' momma, drug her across town on a log chain and ripped off her hand! The only thing I didn't do was set fire to Elvis' polyester jumpsuits!

MAVIS. Priscilla's going to go nuts over the lack of security, and realize that Elvis Land just won't work! Plus Nancy Grace will just have a breakdown over this! You have singlehandedly killed off Elvis Land and saved Graceland!

LURLEEN. I have? I have, haven't I? But…we can't take her back… We'll be arrested…

MAVIS. I tell you what… Let's take Mrs. Presley to a nice park, prop her up against a nice tree, and she can enjoy a beautiful Tennessee morning.

LURLEEN. Do you think Elvis—our lord and savior—will understand?

MAVIS. Hey—he never smited you, did he?

LURLEEN. He sure loved his mama… He must be missing her tons at Graceland.

MAVIS. Well, we need to get Mrs. Presley closed up and to the park before sunrise… Goodbye, Mrs, Presley.

LURLEEN. Farewell, Gladys.

MAVIS. (*pauses—then looks back into coffin*) Lurleen, give Mrs. Presley back her hand.

Bad Coach

by Clint Snyder

MS. JILL. What was your name again?

LILY. My name is Lily, like the flower! Aren't flowers wonderful? And gardens, too! My mother has a—

MS. JILL. Hold it right there, peanut. I asked for your name not your life story, which I'm sure is quite boring and involves a lot of cats.

LILY. Oh, I'm actually deathly allergic to cats. Instead, I have a whole bunch of hermit crabs. I give them each cute little outfits and pretend that I'm the ringleader in a circus of hermit—

MS. JILL. What did I just say?

LILY. You called me a peanut?

MS. JILL. Open your ears, Dumbo! This is an acting class not an open forum for you to talk about why you have no friends.

LILY. Sometimes I like to pretend my hermit crabs are my friends.

MS. JILL. Well, that's very interesting. It would be even more interesting if you shut your cake hole for two seconds and allow me to explain the delicate art of acting. Maybe then my ulcer won't act up.

LILY. You have an ulcer? Is that medical?

MS. JILL. It isn't too bad.…Though I can't have nachos or bad pizza, which makes one-act competitions a nightmare.

LILY. If they're a nightmare then why do you go to them?

MS. JILL. Because I must! It is my craft! Would you ask a bird not to fly?! A fish not to swim?!

LILY. I don't usually talk to animals. That seems a little crazy.

MS. JILL. Well you better get crazy, little miss! Actors breathe crazy.

LILY. How does someone breathe crazy?

MS. JILL. Like this. (*starts inhaling and exhaling at an extremely rapid pace making lots of noise*)

LILY. That's acting?

MS. JILL. Oh, yeah! Good, isn't it?

LILY. Uh.

MS. JILL. Silence! I never listen to my critics, and I certainly don't listen to my students. Or my mother, or my doctor, or my psychiatrist, or that cat that was meowing very strangely at me that one day and sound like he was saying, "I love you." (*in strange cat-like voice*)

LILY. My hermit crabs say I love you sometimes.

MS. JILL. That's insane…which is a good start.

LILY. I mean, they really do tell me they love me. Sometimes they rear range the sponges in their tank into what kind of looks like a heart…if you squint your eyes.

MS. JILL. Yes, I like where you're going with that. Now you'd better start talking to yourself.

LILY. What?

MS. JILL. How do you think you're going to practice your monologue? I'm certainly not going to listen to it fifty thousand times. You're lucky I'm going to sit through it once.

LILY. But isn't that what you're supposed to do? Aren't you the acting coach?

MS. JILL. I am the artist! I create! *That* is what I do. You are the worm wrig gling above ground for that precious bit of fresh air while I circle around you like hungry bird waiting to peck at you. Don't you get dirt on my wings! Don't you dare do it!

LILY. I'll try not to… well… How do I know what monologue I should do? What would I be best at?

MS. JILL. Don't ask yourself that question… Instead, ask yourself what you would be the *least bad* at… Actually, scratch that. You asking questions is a slippery slope that leads to insubordination that eventually ends in me getting annoyed with you and throwing you off a moving vehicle on the way to an audition.

LILY. Is that legal?

MS. JILL. Hey! (*hits her with a fly swatter*) What did I say about questions?!

LILY. Ow! Why did you hit me with a fly swatter?

MS. JILL. (*hits her three times, staccato on each word*) NO! MORE! QUES TIONS! I didn't hit you… It would wrong for a teacher to hit a student; I corrected you, which is what I am supposed to do. This is not a fly swatter… It is a correction tool that also can be used to swat flies… And I throw it at casting directors I don't like.

LILY. What? I'm not exactly sure what you're talking about… The only teacher I've ever had that was allow to hit us was a nun with a ruler… I was never able to measure anything again after that without breaking into tears. I get a little wet-eyed just when someone mentions centimeters or inches.

MS. JILL. You can talk about your life on your own time to your cat.

LILY. Hermit crabs.

MS. JILL. Buh, buh, buh-! *You* don't correct *me*… *I* correct *you*. (*holds up the fly swatter menacingly*)

LILY. Ummm… What I have learned is to stand here and wait for you to ask the questions because for me to ask questions will only end in pain and getting thrown off a bus full of children that are also crazy enough to wake up at an ungodly hour to spend half of the day with you.

MS. JILL. Right… Now for an event… I was thinking something hmmmm… Are you allergic to pet dander?

LILY. How is that relevant? (*gets hit*) Ow!

MS. JILL. It isn't, but that's not for you to decide… Do you have daddy issues?

LILY. No.

MS. JILL. Oh, that's a shame… No sad monologues for you… Do you read a lot?

LILY. Oh, yes, I love to read!

MS. JILL. Great! Maybe you'll do a period piece… What do you read?

LILY. Oh, I love to read romance novels about vampires who rescue young girls and have cute little demon babies with them.

MS. JILL. (*Long pause. MS. JILL stares disgustedly at LILY.)*

LILY. What? (*MS. JILL hits her.*) Ow!

MS. JILL. You sicken me! You know you're the reason they keep writing those horrible things, and by "they" I mean a bunch of monkeys sitting in a room with a typewriter.

LILY. I just think the fantasy is nice.

MS. JILL. The fantasy is that you think you're ever going to find yourself a career as an actor…

LILY. Shouldn't you be more supportive? (*MS. JILL hits her.*) Ow!

MS. JILL. No.

LILY. I knew I should have just been a cheerleader.

MS. JILL. (*sarcastic nice*) Oh, I'm sorry. Is this not working for you? Would you rather it be a nice happy experience where we all hold hands with gnomes and forest creatures and sing happy songs while glitter and sequins hover weightlessly through the air?

LILY. You don't have to be sarcastic. It hurts my self-esteem.

MS. JILL. Have you ever met an acting coach before?

LILY. No.

MS. JILL. (*pause*) YOU ABSOLUTELY SICKEN ME!

LILY. I'm sorry! I'm sorry!

MS. JILL. Don't be sorry; just be the best. Now let me think of something any idiot could do… Poetry! You can do a poem as a monologue; they'll never expect it… You know bibbity boppity boop the cat ran up the… thing.

LILY. Yeah, I know what a poem is. I'm not a complete moron.

MS. JILL. That remains to be seen. (*pause*) So…

LILY. So what? (*LILY is hit again with the fly swatter.*) Ow!

MS. JILL. So do a poem!

LILY. Well, the only poetry I know is the free form slam poetry that I wrote myself, but it's really good.

MS. JILL. I'm sure.

LILY. Ok, here it goes… Blue! (*echoing*) Blue… blue… blue… Yellow… yellow… yellow… Red….Red… These are the primary colors, but does primary mean they are first? (*LILY is swatted again.*) Ow! That's in the piece. You shouldn't hit me because the question was in the piece!

MS. JILL. True, but I wasn't hitting. I was "correcting," and it wasn't because you asked a question… Just because that was awful.

LILY. Hey! I worked hard!

MS. JILL. So do blenders. Besides, you can't do something you wrote anyway.

LILY. I don't think it's fair to judge it if you cut me off before the end.

MS. JILL. I don't think it's fair that you made me sit through five seconds of

it… I mean, red isn't even a primary color.

LILY. Yes, it is!

MS. JILL. You're not doing a poem. That's it!

LILY. I assume you have another monologue for me then?

MS. JILL. Yes, that's why I said "That's it." That's it. That's *it*! The divine theatre muse is flowing through my body… Mmmmm-shakalaka mooo! Mooooo! Great theatre cow in the sky, come to me with your vision, your divine plan for this poor wandering soul without a monologue for auditions.

LILY. Seems like a lot of buildup… This better be good.

MS. JILL. How dare you question me! How dare you question the theatre cow in his infinite wisdom. Listen to her not Moo Moo, she knows not what she speaketh.

LILY. Speaketh?

MS. JILL. Yes speaketh. Haven't you ever read a Shakespeare play before? (*pause*) Wait, don't answer that… I don't think I even want to know… I might lose all faith in humanity completely.

LILY. Well, I read Macbeth one time… I thought the witches were okay.

MS. JILL. Mmm… you read Mm, Mm, Mm- (*clearly frazzled*)

LILY. What's wrong?

MS. JILL. Oh, nothing… Probably nothing in your little world… You're just gunna go on… Go home and feed your stupid cat having NO IDEA THAT YOU JUST DESTROYED THE HOLY THEATRE SANCTITY OF THIS SPACE!

LILY. I did what?

MS. JILL. You spoke the name! You spoke *the* name! The name of the play that must not be named?! SHE KNOWS NOT WHAT SHE DOES GREAT THEATRE COW… SHE IS BUT A STUPID STUPID STUPID GIRL!

LILY. Hey! All I said was Macbeth.

MS. JILL. (*holding her hand over her mouth*) Zip it! (*MS. LILY does a ritual to remove the bad juju. She spits in a circle.*)

LILY. Gross…

MS. JILL. (*chanting*) I saw three ships come sailing in on Christmas Day in the morning. Now we must perform to appease the cow.

LILY. Right… You said you have something good?

MS. JILL. It will not be *good*… It will be perfection because I never give anything less.

LILY. So where's the script?

MS. JILL. I'll ignore the fact that you asked a question because you clearly know nothing of acting… Only the vision matters… The writer… The script has nothing to do with my brilliance and it frankly can't compare.

LILY. Oh…

MS. JILL. You will be doing a scene for two people, but you will be your own partner.

LILY. Ummmmm…

MS. JILL. Don't question it, just do it… Do it… *Duet*… Ha! Sometimes my own brilliance surprises me. Now stand right there and pretend… Uhhh… This is good… This is very good… Pretend that you're pregnant and the other you is the baby and you're talking to yourself. Go! NOW!

LILY. Ahhhh! Ahhh… ummm… Gogo gaga! I'm just a baby hanging out here in the womb… Doin' baby stuff… This is weird.

MS. JILL. Never break character! Now be the mother.

LILY. That's uhh… Nice baby I've been making… Yup… I've definitely got a baby on the way…

MS. JILL. Now the baby!

LILY. I want my bottle… but actually I don't think I need one yet… because I got this cord thingy…

MS. JILL. Mother!

LILY. Ummm… I'm ready to just pop and uhhh… burst and explode and I CAN'T DO IT! I CAN'T!!! THIS IS THE CRAZIEST WEIRDEST THING THAT I HAVE EVER DONE IN MY ENTIRE LIFE!

MS. JILL. Welcome to acting…

LILY. No! Not welcome to acting. *Goodbye acting*. I'll go watch T.V. or play tennis or have a life like normal kids have.

MS. JILL. Only traitors play tennis!

LILY. Then I guess I'm a traitor! GOODBYE!

MS. JILL. She would have wasted that monologue anyway… I could feel her sucking the brilliance right out of the room like a vacuum… Maybe I'll dress up like a little twit and enter myself as an actor with a fake name and use it myself, acting a part within a part… Brilliant! The great theatre cow in the sky must be smiling down at me today!

Manic Cure

by Clint Snyder

DR. TELLY. So… What exact seems to be the problem?

TAMMY. Well… umm… My dog won't stop piddling on the floor and my boyfriend is a total jerk, but my sister keeps telling me just give him time, he'll come around… but she smokes a lot of cigarettes, so it's more like… (*imitating the voice of a heavy smoker*) Just give him time; he'll come around. Which I really don't think she's going to be coming around much if she keeps smoking cigarettes the way she does.

DR. TELLY. I mean your medical problem—the reason why you came to see a doctor today. Do you see my nametag? It says Dr. Telly.

TAMMY. Right. Say, that's a nice nametag.

DR. TELLY. Forget about the nametag!

TAMMY. Geez! I knew doctors had bad handwriting, but I didn't know they had bad attitudes, too.

DR. TELLY. I don't have a bad attitude!

TAMMY. Are you sure?

DR. TELLY. Are you going to keep wasting my time? I'm a very busy woman.

TAMMY. I'm at the doctor because I have medical condition. It's very…medical. (*pause)* You're a woman?

DR. TELLY. (*pause*) Yes…

TAMMY. And a doctor?

DR. TELLY. (*pauses, then sighs*) Yes…

TAMMY. I didn't know that we could be doctors…

DR. TELLY. Excuse me!? I'm not going to even dignify that with a response.

TAMMY. Whatever that means…

DR. TELLY. It means get out of my office this instant!

TAMMY. But you haven't helped me at all! Aren't doctors supposed to help people with their medical conditions? (*pleading*) It's *very* medical.

DR. TELLY. I think you might need a different kind of doctor.

TAMMY. Oh, like a man?

DR. TELLY. Look, if you make one more comment about women being doctors, I'm going to take those paddles off the wall that we use to start people's hearts and use them in reverse!

TAMMY. Cool, do they work like that?

DR. TELLY. Do you want to find out? (*sarcastic*)

TAMMY. Maybe…if we could find, like, a dead frog or bird or, like, a goldfish and bring them back to life then they would be like zombies. We could have our own reality show.

DR. TELLY. That's really not how it works.

TAMMY. What are you, some kind of rocket scientist?

DR. TELLY. No, I'm a doctor.

TAMMY. Like that even means anything anymore.

DR. TELLY. It does. It means I'm a doctor.

TAMMY. Well, I'll tell you one thing: my cousin is also a doctor. He got a little thingy in an email saying that he could be a real life doctor with a certificate and everything. All he had to do was mail in a large amount of money to some weird country…Vu..vue..zuela… I think? Then he would get a certificate and everything. That certificate never came, but he did pop a zit on my sister's face once. If that doesn't make someone a doctor, then I don't know what does. Other than being a man, maybe.

DR. TELLY. That's it! (*goes to grab the paddles*)

TAMMY. Okay! Okay! I'll drop it. Women can be doctors. You seem really bent out of shape about that.

DR. TELLY. Women can be lawyers and judges and heads of state and even the president if they want.

TAMMY. Then can I be a doctor? Me! A doctor! Can I please?

DR. TELLY. (*pause.*) No.

TAMMY. Why not?

DR. TELLY. Because it takes years of medical training and schooling and tests that I'm sure you would not pass. Correction: I don't think you could figure out how to open the door to get to the tests that you would undoubtedly fail. Come to think of it, I'm not entirely sure how you managed to open the doors to get into this building.

TAMMY. They were automatic! I went in and out of them twenty-three times because I felt like I was on a spaceship.

DR. TELLY. (*Pause.*) Twenty-three huh?

TAMMY. Yep.

DR. TELLY. I'm surprised you can count that high.

TAMMY. Oh yeah, got all the way up to thirty-two once. How do you know I haven't already passed those tests? How do you know that I haven't already figured it out! Maybe I'm not really here with a medical condition at all… Maybe I'm just here to test you…from the board of people that test people about medical things.

DR TELLY: (*flatly*) Just a hunch I guess…

TAMMY. Well alright, Ms. Smarty-Pants, or khakis, or blue…I don't really know what you would call those.

DR. TELLY. Scrubs.

TAMMY. Well that's a funny name for those. I would just call them blue-khaki-doctor-pants. My point is that if I can't be a doctor can I be the president instead?

DR. TELLY. NO!

TAMMY. Well, why not?

DR. TELLY. I cannot even begin to list the multitude of reasons why you would be the worst possible choice to lead our nation. If you were in power, every branch of government would implode. The state of our nation would descend into utter and complete chaos resulting in an Armageddon-like situation where anarchy rules and we are

governed by our most primal and basic instincts.

TAMMY. (*Pause*) I can't understand you when you use words like that. You still haven't answered my question.

DR. TELLY. (*slaps palm against face in frustration*) Because I wouldn't vote for you. I don't think you would have a good enough slogan to put on a button. How about that for an answer?

TAMMY. Well, I wouldn't need you to vote for me because I would still have plenty of supporters that would back me. Besides, you haven't even heard my slogan. I happen to be an expert rhymer. (*pause*) Don't you want to know what it is? (*pauses, then louder*) Don't you want to know what it is? I swear you've got to use some of those cotton ear stick thingies because you don't hear very well. (*clears throat*) My slogan is: Vote for Tammy! Your hands won't be clammy! Ha! Because the first thing I would do is make everyone wear mittens all day. (*DR. TELLY has become increasingly more agi tated.)*

DR. TELLY. Look, if you don't tell me what your medical problem is in five seconds then I'm calling security!

TAMMY. Wait, did the five seconds already start, or are you going to give me a "go"? You're going to have to give me a "Go!" or, like, wave your hands, or maybe if you could find one of those little racecar flags and wave it when I star-

DR. TELLY. SECURIT-

TAMMY. (*muffling*) Shhhhh!!! Shhhh!!!! Shhhh!!!!

DR. TELLY. (*muffled*) Mhhhhmmpphhh!!!

TAMMY. We're just going to calm it down. (*petting her hair*) Good doctor. That's a good doctor.

DR TELLY. (*resigned*) Mmmmph…

TAMMY. Don't you know you're in a hospital? They have beds in hospitals! People sleep in those beds, and they cannot sleep in them if you're in here yelling about secru-taries.

DR. TELLY. YES! I know I'm in a hospital! I work here! I help people! That's all I want to do is to help people, but some people— you namely—need more help than I am willing or able to provide!

TAMMY. Did you hear a word I just said about yelling. This is a hospital, miss. A HOSPITAL!

DR. TELLY. I know!

TAMMY. Well, if you want to help people so badly, then you should quiet down. I can grab a muzzle from the car if you feel like you might need it.

DR. TELLY. I'm not sure if I'm more disturbed by the fact that you have a muzzle or that you know what that is.

TAMMY. It's one of those leather do-hickeys I strap on the kids sometimes when I go to the grocery store to get them to be quiet.

DR. TELLY. You're sick.

TAMMY. I know! That's why I'm in a hospital. (*Dr. Telly sighs loudly.*) Oh, I

see what you mean about the grocery store. I know this isn't it. I'll tell you one thing: it is a very sick world when a woman can't even walk down the aisle of a grocery store in silence and shop for her cheese poofs.

DR. TELLY. What do you want? Money? Jewels? You're not going to chain me up and make me part of your hillbilly half-bred family are you?! ARE YOU!? I CAN'T PLAY THE BANJO! (*sobs*)

TAMMY. Oh, it's okay. Plenty of people can't play the banjo. You don't have to cry.

DR. TELLY. That's not why I'm crying.

TAMMY. Well you said, "I CAN'T PLAY THE BANJO! Boohooohoo!" and started crying just like that.

DR. TELLY. Look, you. Just kill me and use my carcass as a container for pumpkin seeds or whatever you plan on doing with me.

TAMMY. Oh, I just wanted to see a doctor about this problem with my hands.

DR. TELLY. You do? (*stops crying, smiles a bit*)

TAMMY. Yep.

DR. TELLY. Well, that's great!

TAMMY. No, it's not. It scares me something awful!

DR. TELLY. (*taking notes)* Right… right.

TAMMY. Don't you want to take my measurements or something first?

DR. TELLY. No! Ick! (*pause*) I mean why? Do you want me to?

TAMMY. No, that's okay.

DR. TELLY. As you were saying?

TAMMY. Well, the trouble really started when I was eating a sloppy joe.

DR. TELLY. Uh-uh… (*scribbling.*) Sloppy joe.

TAMMY. What's that you're writing?

DR. TELLY. Just doctor's notes…(*mumbling under her breath)* My last will and testament.

TAMMY. Right, so I'm sitting there, and I'm just chomping away at this thing…

DR. TELLY. (*scribbling.*) …chomping…

TAMMY. …you know, biting?

DR. TELLY. I know what chomping means. Just continue.

TAMMY. Well, I was biting away and laughing because the dog was jumping on my lap because he knew sloppy joes. They're sloppy, and they get all over the place. Then he eats what falls on the floor. So I'm laughing at the dog, and I go to take another bite and AHHHHHHHHHH!!!!

DR. TELLY. AHHHHHH!!! (*genuinely frightened.*)

TAMMY. That's just what I said, I said, "AHHHHHH!" because I had bit my finger and you know what?

DR. TELLY. (*TAMMY holds her finger up and DR. TELLY leans back.)* No, what?

TAMMY. I noticed these little white thingies on the ends of them that I ain't never noticed before. So I said, "Gerald, I'd better go see a doctor about this."

DR. TELLY. You've got to be kidding me…

TAMMY. I know, right?

DR. TELLY. No it's not that I-

TAMMY. And then a *really* weird thing happened when I went to take a shower the next week. I was looking down and I saw the same white thingies on my toes, the exact same thing!

DR. TELLY. You have got to be kidding me!

TAMMY. Here, do you want to see?

DR. TELLY. No, keep your shoes on! KEEP YOUR SHOES ON!

TAMMY. Why? Is it contagious? It's not contagious is it? I hope Gerald didn't catch it!

DR. TELLY. No.

TAMMY. (*gasps*) Is it deadly? Am I going to die? I have so much to live for!

DR. TELLY. (*to self*) I'm sure.

TAMMY. Just give to me straight, doctor. I can take it.

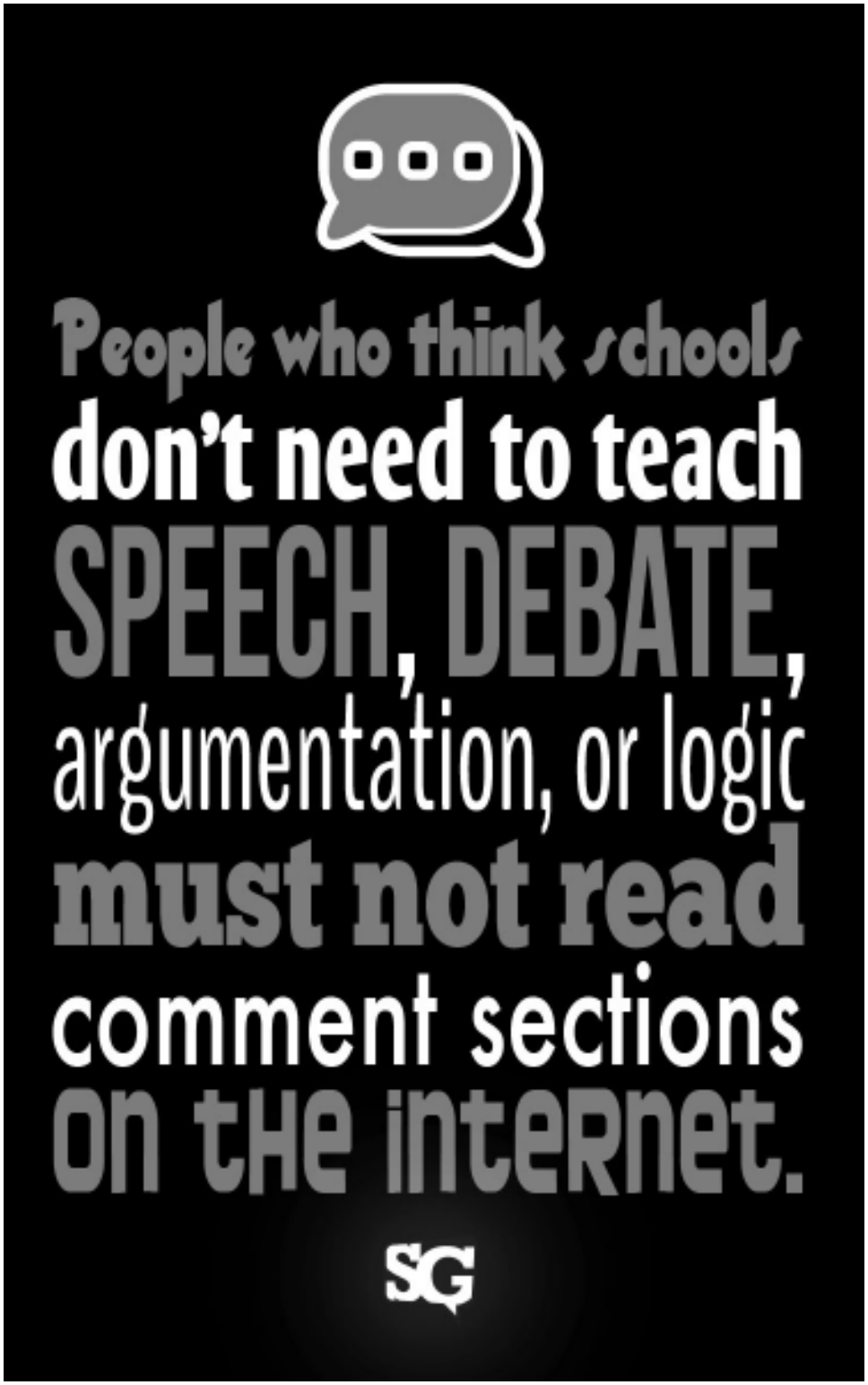
DR. TELLY. They're nails.

TAMMY. Not nails! (*confused)* Wait, are you saying that I'm going to need to get nails, like those little metal pins Gerald has in his head? He went through one of those security thingies at the airport once. I swear you would have thought they had found a terrorist they way they jumped on him. Luckily, he only bled a little.

DR. TELLY. NO! NAILS! NAILS! NAILS! LIKE FINGER NAILS! YOU IDIOT! YOU ARE BY FAR THE DUMBEST PERSON I HAVE EVER MET! You have made me completely lose all faith in humanity. And you know what else?! I quit! I quit! I QUIT!!! I CAN'T SIT HERE AND LISTEN TO YOU PRATTLE ON ABOUT SLOPPY JOES OR DOGS OR NAILS FOR ONE MORE SECOND! Someone else can do it! In fact you do it! Take the jacket! Goodbye!

TAMMY. I told her I could be a doctor. Gerald is gonna be so proud of me!





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